gather single-line and multiline input fields. You may specify a `placeholder`, which will be displayed inside the field until the user provides a value. Not every browser supports this function, but those that don't simply will display an empty box. Since this will degrade gracefully, there's no need for you to design to the least common denominator—make use of this feature, because those who can see it will benefit from it immediately.

Placeholders are one of the many small "fit and finish" features provided with HTML5, and once again, Rails is ready even if the browser your users have installed is not. You can use the `search_field`, `telephone_field`, `url_field`, `email_field`, `number_field`, and `range_field` helpers to prompt for a specific type of input. How the browser will make use of this information varies. Some may display the field slightly differently to more clearly identify its function. Safari on Mac, for example, will display search fields with rounded corners and will insert a little `x` for clearing the field once data entry begins. Some may provide added validation. For example, Opera will validate URL fields prior to submission. The iPad will even adjust the virtual onscreen keyboard to provide ready access to characters such as the `@` sign when entering an email address.

Although the support for these functions varies by browser, those that don't provide extra support for these functions simply display a plain, unadorned input box. Once again, nothing is gained by waiting. If you have an input field that's expected to contain an email address, don't simply use `text_field`—go ahead and start using `email_field` now.

Lines 14, 24, and 34 demonstrate three different ways to provide a constrained set of options. Although the display may vary a bit from browser to browser, these approaches are all well supported across all browsers. The `select` method is particularly flexible—it can be passed an `Enumeration` as shown here, an array of pairs of name-value pairs, or a `Hash`. A number of form options helpers[107] are available to produce such lists from various sources, including the database.

Finally, lines 39 and 44 show prompts for a date and time, respectively. As you might expect by now, Rails provides plenty of options here too.[108]